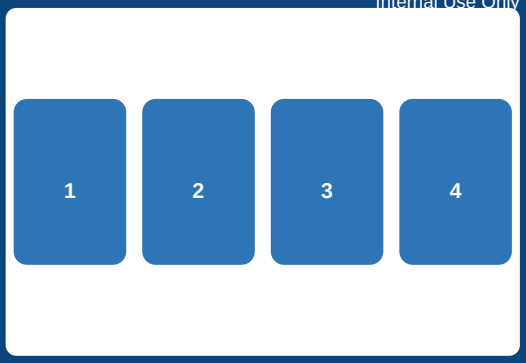
MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS

Internal Use Only

Revision of a Standard

Update existing standards in a controlled, documented way to reflect process improvements, lessons learned, or regulatory



WHEN TO USE

After a process improvement is implemented; when a standard is found to no longer accurately describe what should be done.

HOW TO APPLY — STEPS

1. Identify the specific trigger and reason for the revision
2. Review the change with all people affected by the standard before finalising
3. Update the document with clear version control and date of revision
4. Communicate the change explicitly — do not rely on people noticing a new version number
5. Archive the previous version — never delete previous versions

PRACTITIONER TIP

! Standards that are never revised are either perfect — which is unlikely — or ignored — which is the more likely explanation.

KEY OUTPUTS

- Revised standard with updated version number
- Summary of changes from previous version
- Retraining record for affected personnel

HOW TO MEASURE SUCCESS

Time from improvement to standard update; number of out-of-date standards identified in audit

TOOL CATEGORY

Management Systems